

Hexuan Li

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Education	Vanderbilt University Ph.D. in Economics, expected May 2027	Nashville, TN
	Georgetown University Master of Public Policy, 2019	Washington, DC
	Renmin University of China B.Eng. Information System Management, 2015	Beijing, China

Fields Applied Microeconomics, Health Economics, Public Economics

Working Papers **When Health Insurance Extends Beyond Health: Postpartum Medicaid and Household Spending**

Job Market Paper (with Jessica Kiser)

Abstract: We study how Medicaid coverage affects retention, household spending, and resource reallocation using coverage extensions from the Families First Coronavirus Response Act (FFCRA), which mandated continuous enrollment and effectively extended coverage for women enrolled in Medicaid during pregnancy. Using monthly product-level purchase records from the NielsenIQ Consumer Panel (2019–2020) and Pregnancy Risk Assessment Monitoring Survey (PRAMS) data linked to state-specific Medicaid income thresholds, we analyze how household spending responded to FFCRA among households with newborns. Difference-in-differences estimates show that Medicaid retention for newly eligible women increases by around 65 percent and that extended postpartum coverage roughly doubles spending on baby care products and increases total household expenditures by about 21 percent. The spending increase occurs after 60 days postpartum, consistent with the coverage extension relaxing household budget constraints. We find suggestive evidence that the spending response operates through reduced out-of-pocket medical costs rather than changes in labor supply.

Public Long-term Care Insurance and Female Labor Force Participation: Evidence from China's Pilot Program

Conditionally accepted, Journal of Public Economics

Abstract: The global rise in aging populations has heightened the need for long-term care, presenting significant financial challenges for elderly households. In response to China's rapidly aging population and the decline in traditional family-based care, the government launched a Long-term Care Insurance pilot program

in 2016, expanding to cover 49 cities by 2020. Despite existing research on the program’s impacts, there has been limited exploration of its spillover effects on non-elderly populations. This study examines how China’s pilot program affects the labor market outcomes of adult children of eligible elders. Using data from the China Family Panel Studies and a staggered difference-in-differences design based on Callaway and Sant’Anna (2021), I find an 11–15 percent increase in employment probability for female adult children following the program’s launch, with especially robust effects among lower-educated and older women.

Work in Progress	Do School-Based Health Centers Affect Juvenile Crime and Delinquency? <i>(with Lindsey Bullinger and Analisa Packham)</i>	
Presentations	Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2026, planned
	Applied Workshop at Florida State University	2026, planned
	American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference	2026
	Vanderbilt Empirical Applied Microeconomics Seminar	2026, 2024
	Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2025
	Vanderbilt Graduate Research Day	2025
Awards	Walter B. Noel Dissertation Fellowship	2026–2027
	Department of Economics Award for Best Third-Year Paper, Vanderbilt University	2025
	Kirk Dornbush Summer Research Grant, Vanderbilt University	2025
	College of Arts and Science Fellowship, Vanderbilt University	2021–2027
	Merit-based Scholarship, McCourt School of Public Policy, Georgetown University	2017–2019
Professional Experience	Research Assistant, Vanderbilt University <i>(for Dr. Analisa Packham)</i>	Jun–Aug, 2026
	Construct county-level datasets and conduct empirical analysis for a study of the effects of school-based health centers on juvenile crime and delinquency.	
	Research Analyst, Peterson Institute for International Economics	2019–2021
	Built and maintained a harmonized U.S. trade-barriers database with 30M+ records from 1970–2021, ensuring reproducible workflows and data integrity across projects.	

- Conducted empirical analysis to quantify trade policy impacts across major U.S. industries, producing estimates for 20+ reports, working papers, and public commentaries.
- Translated complex empirical results into clear charts, summaries, and talking points for senior economists' engagement with media, government, and policy stakeholders under tight deadlines.

Research Intern, Global Economy and Development Program, Brookings Institution Jan–Apr, 2019

- Applied regression and comparative-case methods to state capacity research, translating findings into visualizations and summaries for 2 book chapters and policy reports.

Research Assistant, McCourt School of Public Policy, Georgetown University Jun–Aug, 2018

- Compiled and analyzed data on 800 Investor-State Dispute Settlement cases, examining arbitration outcomes and government participation in a setting relevant to litigation and regulatory analysis.

Program Assistant, The Alumni Association, Renmin University of China 2015–2017

- Coordinated large-scale outreach and event logistics reaching 2,500+ participants, supporting effective communication and stakeholder engagement across regions.

Teaching Experience

Vanderbilt University

Guest Lecturer: Health Economics

Teaching Assistant: Econometrics (Ph.D. Level); Statistical Analysis (M.A. Level); Health Economics; Game Theory; Economic Statistics

Georgetown University

Teaching Assistant: Intermediate Microeconomics and Macroeconomics (M.A. Level)

Service and Leadership

Referee, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management* 2024, 2026

Discussant, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting 2026

Director of Research, East Asian Policy Student Association, Georgetown University 2018–2019

Vice President of Student Union, School of Information, Renmin University of China 2013–2014

References

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